

Apply for a Science Corps Fellowship - Entry #3234

Name

Gamage Sugandima Nishadi Weragoda

Email

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Gender

Female

City, state, and country of residence

Cleveland Heights, Ohio, USA

Nationality

Sri Lankan

When did or will you finish your PhD?

2023 December

University Education

PhD in Physics, Case Western Reserve University, Cleveland, Ohio, December 2023

BSc (Hons) in Computational Physics, University of Colombo, Sri Lanka, 2017

What are your reasons for applying to be a Science Corps fellow?

I am a first-generation college student from a third-world country. I benefited from the availability of free education in my home country, Sri Lanka, where I completed my primary to college-level education. Thanks to my solid education back home, I was able to pursue my passion for science further by securing a fully funded PhD position at a top U.S. university like CWRU. I have experienced firsthand the life-changing difference a STEM education can make for an individual coming from an underprivileged background. As such, I have always been passionate about science education and outreach. It is

my wish to inspire a love for science in others so that their lives will be all the more enriching for it. Science Corps would be the perfect place for me to start my journey in science education and outreach.

In addition to your studies, describe any relevant experiences that have prepared you for a Science Corps fellowship.

- Vice-President of Sri Lankan Student Association. CWRU (2021-2023).

In response to the challenges posed by the pandemic, I founded the association with the aim of creating a nurturing environment for the Sri Lankan student community. I led a diverse group of student officers in organizing various cultural events and offering support to incoming Sri Lankan students, ensuring they feel at home.

- Reviewer and Judge, SOURCE Undergraduate Research Symposium. CWRU (2021-2023).

- Physics Olympiad Organizing Committee UOC (2014 2016)

Worked in a diverse team of 30 officers to organize multiple outreach events and workshops for rural high schools, which resulted in an almost 30% increase in rural student participation.

- Local Committee Vice-President AIESEC UOC (2014 2016)

Led a diverse student team and collaborated with local grassroots organizations to create positive social impact in areas of education and women empowerment.

Where do you imagine yourself professionally in the future? Check all that apply.

Academic scientist in academia

Doing science in industry

In science education

In science outreach

Expand on your selection above and describe where you imagine yourself professionally in the near (two year) and long-term (ten year) future.

In the near future, I anticipate an appointment in a medical physics residency while actively participating in physics education and outreach initiatives.

In the long term, my aspirations involve achieving board certification as a clinical medical physicist and securing a faculty position that would allow me to actively contribute to both research and education. Furthermore, I envision an increased level of involvement in education and outreach programs, taking on expanded responsibilities and exerting a more significant influence.

CV/Resume

 [resume.pdf](#)

How did you find out about Science Corps?

University email list

Any other comments/questions?

Empty

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